Laszlo **Szabo**

Consultant Transplant Surgeon
Cardiff and Vale University HB, Cardiff, UK
Laszlo.Szabo@wales.nhs.uk 0000-0002-6881-1542 Laszlo75 drszabolaszlo

Education

Specialist in Surgery (CCT equivalent) — *Debrecen, Hungary*
Hungarian National Board of Surgery — *1999 - 2006*

Medical Doctor — *Debrecen, Hungary*
Medical and Health Science Centre; University of Debrecen; Hungary — *1993 - 1999*

Qualifications

European Diploma in Transplantation Surgery — *Paris*
European Board of Surgery, Division of Transplantation — *2009*

- Module 1: Multiorgan retrieval | Module 2: Kidney Transplantation

European Diploma in Transplantation Surgery — *Brussels*
European Board of Surgery, Division of Transplantation — *2015*

- Module 3: Pancreas Transplantation

Certificates

CS50's Introduction to Computer Science
Harvard University / edX ↗ — *2026*

Claude with the Anthropic API
Anthropic Academy ↗ — *2026*

AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations
Anthropic Academy ↗ — *2026*

Work Experience

Consultant Transplant Surgeon — *Cardiff, UK*
Cardiff Transplant Unit, Cardiff and Vale University Health Board — *2012 - Present*

Clinical Fellow in Transplant Surgery and Organ Retrieval — *Cardiff, UK*
Cardiff Transplant Unit, Cardiff and Vale University Health Board — *2011 - 2012*

Surgeon, Assistant Lecturer — *Debrecen, Hungary*
Institute of Surgery, Medical and Health Science Centre, University of Debrecen — *2006 - 2011*

Surgical Trainee — *Debrecen, Hungary*
Institute of Surgery, Medical and Health Science Centre, University of Debrecen — *1999 - 2006*

Leadership Roles

Transplant and Vascular Access Lead
Welsh Kidney Network *2024 - 2026*

Clinical Lead for Governance
Cardiff Transplant Unit *2021 - present*

Clinical Lead for Organ Utilisation
Cardiff Transplant Unit *2020 - present*

Research

Principal Investigator

PITHIA
Pre-implantation Trial of Histopathology In renal Allografts

POWAR
Prophylaxis of Wound Infections - Antibiotics in Renal Donation

COPE-COMPARE
Oxygenated versus standard cold perfusion preservation in kidney transplantation

COPE-POMP
Pre-implantation oxygenated hypothermic machine perfusion reconditioning after cold storage versus cold storage alone in expanded criteria donor kidneys from brain dead donors

PAVE
Paclitaxel-assisted balloon angioplasty of venous stenosis in haemodialysis access

Skills

Surgical Skills
Kidney and pancreas transplantation, organ retrieval, normothermic regional perfusion, vascular access

Languages
Hungarian (native), English (fluent), French (basic)

Data Science
R, Positron, Quarto, Typst, Power BI

Programming
Python, SQL, HTML/CSS (CS50)

AI & LLMs
Claude API, prompt engineering, AI-assisted research workflows

Publications

Owen, R., Kourounis, G., Karki, B., Connor, K., Brown, C., Kayani, K., Elzawahry, M., Blanco, R., Schilirò, D., Smith, P., Mehew, J., Manook, M., Scuffell, C., Amer, A., Tingle, S., Thompson, E. R., & CRAFT Study Collaborators. (2026). Multicentre Collaborative Prospective Cohort Study Investigating the Impact of Enhanced Recovery After Surgery on Kidney Transplant Outcomes: The CRAFT Study. *Transplant International*, *38*, 15541. https://doi.org/10.3389/ti.2025.15541

Mujeeb, M., Borbas, B., Tanase, A., Sandhu, B., Barnett, N., Zakri, R., Dabare, D., Patel, K., Okafor, U., Ayorinde, T., Chan, A., Hanji, S., Motallebzadeh, R., Alawad, A., Brooker, V., Chalklin, C., Gupta, S., Szabo, L., Malik, A., … Aroori, S. (2025). Causes of Prolonged Cold Ischemia Time After Arrival of Deceased Donor Kidney at Implanting Center: Results From a Prospective Audit. *Clinical Transplantation*, *39*(8), e70227. https://doi.org/10.1111/ctr.70227

Summers, D. M., Ayorinde, J. O., Neil, D. A., Hemming, K., Smith, L., Mehew, J., Thomas, H., Brown, R., Phillips, S., Laing, E., Sidders, A., Deary, A. J., Johnson, R. J., Bardsley, V., Thiru, S., Griffiths, M. H., Perera, R., Cain, O., Roufosse, C., … Pettigrew, G. J. (2025). Evaluation of a National Digital Pre-Implantation Biopsy Service for Deceased-Donor Kidney Transplantation in the UK (Pithia Trial); a Stepped-Wedge Cluster Randomised Registry Trial. *The Lancet Regional Health - Europe*, *56*, 101390. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.lanepe.2025.101390

Kingsmore, D. B., Edgar, B., Aitken, E., Calder, F., Franchin, M., Geddes, C., Inston, N., Jackson, A., Jones, R. G., Karydis, N., Kasthuri, R., Mestres, G., Papadakis, G., Sivaprakasam, R., Stephens, M., Stevenson, K., Stove, C., Szabo, L., Thomson, P. C., … White, R. D. (2024). Quality Assurance in Surgical Trials of Arteriovenous Grafts for Haemodialysis: A Systematic Review, a Narrative Exploration and Expert Recommendations. *The Journal of Vascular Access*, 11297298241236521. https://doi.org/10.1177/11297298241236521

Koimtzis, G., Geropoulos, G., Chalklin, C., Karniadakis, I., Szabo, L., Ilham, M. A., Stephens, M., Asderakis, A., & Khalid, U. (2024). The Influence of Socioeconomic Deprivation on Outcomes in Transplant Patients Infected with SARS-CoV-2 in Wales. *Clinical Transplantation*, *38*(1), e15245. https://doi.org/10.1111/ctr.15245

Edgar, B., Kingsmore, D. B., Aitken, E., Calder, F., Franchin, M., Geddes, C., Inston, N., Jackson, A., Jones, R. G., Karydis, N., Kasthuri, R., Mestres, G., Papadakis, G., Sivaprakasam, R., Stephens, M., Stevenson, K., Stove, C., Szabo, L., Thomson, P., … White, R. D. (2023). Quality Assurance in Surgical Trials of Arteriovenous Grafts for Haemodialysis: Protocol for a Systematic Review. *BMJ Open*, *13*(7), e71646. https://doi.org/10.1136/bmjopen-2023-071646

Kingsmore, D., White, R. D., Mestres, G., Stephens, M., Calder, F., Papadakis, G., Aitken, E., Jackson, A., Inston, N., Jones, R. G., Geddes, C., Stevenson, K., Szabo, L., Thomson, P., Stove, C., Kasthuri, R., Edgar, B., Tozzi, M., Franchin, M., … Karydis, N. (2023). Recruitment into Randomised Trials of Arteriovenous Grafts: A Systematic Review. *The Journal of Vascular Access*, 112972982311584. https://doi.org/10.1177/11297298231158413

Asderakis, A., Khalid, U., Koimtzis, G., Ponsford, M. J., Szabo, L., Chalklin, C., Bramhall, K., Grant, L., Moat, S. J., Humphreys, I. R., & Jolles, S. R. (2022). An Analysis of Serological Response and Infection Outcomes Following Oxford-AstraZeneca (AZD1222) and Pfizer-BioNTech (mRNA BNT162b2) SARS-CoV-2 Vaccines in Kidney and Kidney-pancreas Transplants. *Transplantation*, *106*(7), 1421–1429. https://doi.org/10.1097/tp.0000000000004105

Asderakis, A., Sabah, T. K., Watkins, W. J., Khalid, U., Szabo, L., Stephens, M. R., Griffin, S., & Chavez, R. (2022). Thymoglobulin versus Alemtuzumab versus Basiliximab Kidney Transplantation from Donors After Circulatory Death. *Kidney International Reports*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ekir.2022.01.1042

Husen, P., Boffa, C., Jochmans, I., Krikke, C., Davies, L., Mazilescu, L., Brat, A., Knight, S., Wettstein, D., Cseprekal, O., Banga, N., Bellini, M. I., Szabo, L., Ablorsu, E., Darius, T., Quiroga,

I., Mourad, M., Pratschke, J., Papalois, V., … Paul, A. (2021). Oxygenated End-Hypothermic Machine Perfusion in Expanded Criteria Donor Kidney Transplant. *JAMA Surgery*, *156*(6), 517–525. https://doi.org/10.1001/jamasurg.2021.0949

Karunanithy, N., Robinson, E. J., Ahmad, F., Burton, J. O., Calder, F., Coles, S., Das, N., Dorling, A., Forman, C., Jaffer, O., Lawman, S., Lakshminarayan, R., Lewlellyn, R., Peacock, J. L., Ramnarine, R., Mesa, I. R., Shaikh, S., Simpson, J., Steiner, K., … Robson, M. G. (2021). A Multicenter Randomized Controlled Trial Indicates That Paclitaxel-Coated Balloons Provide No Benefit during Angioplasty of Arteriovenous Fistulas. *Kidney International*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.kint.2021.02.040

Sabah, T. K., Khalid, U., Ilham, M. A., Ablorsu, E., Szabo, L., Griffin, S., Chavez, R., & Asderakis, A. (2021). Induction with ATG in DCD Kidney Transplantation; Efficacy and Relation of Dose and Cell Markers on Delayed Graft Function and Renal Function. *Transplant Immunology*, 101388. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.trim.2021.101388

Jochmans, I., Brat, A., Davies, L., Hofker, H. S., Leemkolk, F. E. M. van de, Leuvenink, H. G. D., Knight, S. R., Pirenne, J., Ploeg, R. J., (COPE), COMPARE Trial Collaboration and Consortium for Organ Preservation in Europe, Abramowicz, D., Banga, N., Bemelman, F. J., Betjens, M. G., Burns, R., Chiocchia, V., Christiaans, M. H., Darius, T., Jonge, J. de, … Ysebaert, D. (2020). Oxygenated versus Standard Cold Perfusion Preservation in Kidney Transplantation (COMPARE): A Randomised, Double-Blind, Paired, Phase 3 Trial. *The Lancet*, *396*(10263), 1653–1662. https://doi.org/10.1016/s0140-6736(20)32411-9

Khalid, U., Ilham, M. A., Szabo, L., Saunders, E., McMillan, S., & Stephens, M. R. (2020). Arterio-Venous Fistula Surgery Can Be Safely Delivered in the COVID-19 Pandemic Era. *The Journal of Vascular Access*, 112972982098316. https://doi.org/10.1177/1129729820983166

Ahmed, Z., Uwechue, R., Chandak, P., Dellen, D. van, Barwell, J., Heap, S., Szabo, L., Hemsley, C., Olsburgh, J., Kessaris, N., & Mamode, N. (2019). Prophylaxis of Wound Infections-antibiotics in Renal Donation (POWAR). *Annals of Surgery*. https://doi.org/10.1097/SLA.0000000000003666

Khalid, U., Jameel, M., Sabah, T., Szabo, L., Ilham, M. A., Chavez, R., Ablorsu, E., & Asderakis, A. (2019). Older Donation After Circulatory Death Kidneys for Older Recipients: A Single-Center Experience. *Transplantation Proceedings*, *51*(3), 701–706. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.transproceed.2019.01.081

Khalid, U., Zaidi, A., Cheang, A., Horvath, S., Szabo, L., Ilham, M. A., & Stephens, M. R. (2018). `Educational' Deprivation Is Associated with PD Peritonitis. *Peritoneal Dialysis International*, *38*(4), 251–256. https://doi.org/10.3747/pdi.2017.00098

Khalid, U., Ablorsu, E., Szabo, L., Jenkins, R. H., Bowen, T., Chavez, R., & Fraser, D. J. (2016). MicroRNA-21 (miR-21) Expression in Hypothermic Machine Perfusate May Be Predictive of Early Outcomes in Kidney Transplantation. *Clinical Transplantation*, *30*(2), 99–104. https://doi.org/10.1111/ctr.12679

Khalid, U., Asderakis, A., Rana, T., Szabo, L., Chavez, R., Ilham, M., & Ablorsu, E. (2016). Dual Kidney Transplantation Offers a Valuable Source for Kidneys With Good Functional Outcome. *Transplantation Proceedings*, *48*(6), 1981–1985. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.transproceed.2016.02.083

Kovács, D. Á., Asztalos, L., Laczik, R., Fedor, R., Szabó, L., \dag Lőcsey, L., & Soltész, P. (2016). [Favourable effects of kidney transplantation on vascular condition of patients: Potential prognostic significance of non-invasive measurement of arterial stiffness]. *Orvosi Hetilap*, *157*(24), 956–963. https://doi.org/10.1556/650.2016.30412

Nemes, B., Fedor, R., Kanyári, Z., \dag Lőcsey, L., Juhász, F., Kovács, D. Á., Zádori, G., Győry, F., Szabó, R. P., Zsom, L., Szabó, T., Illésy, L., Szabó-Pap, M., Kincses, Z., Szabó, L., Damjanovich, L., Balla, J., & Asztalos, L. (2016). [First Outcomes, since Being Full Member of Eurotransplant.

A Single Center Experience of Cadaveric Kidney Transplantation]. *Orvosi Hetilap*, *157*(24), 925–937. https://doi.org/10.1556/650.2016.30501

Khalid, U., Powell-Chandler, A., Sabah, T., Horvath, S., Morris, R., Ilham, M. A., & Stephens, M. R. (2015). The Influence of Socioeconomic Deprivation on Early Outcomes in Vascular Access Surgery. *The Journal of Vascular Access*, *16*(6), 480–485. https://doi.org/10.5301/jva.5000406

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Szabó, L., Szentandrássy, N., Kistamás, K., Hegyi, B., Ruzsnavszky, F., Váczi, K., Horváth, B., Magyar, J., Bányász, T., Pál, B., & Nánási, P. P. (2013). Effects of Tacrolimus on Action Potential Configuration and Transmembrane Ion Currents in Canine Ventricular Cells. *Naunyn-Schmiedeberg's Archives of Pharmacology*, *386*(3), 239–246. https://doi.org/10.1007/s00210-012-0823-2

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Fedor, R., Asztalos, L., Löcsey, L., Szabó, L., Mányiné, I., Fagyas, M., Lizanecz, E., & Tóth, A. (2010). Insertion/Deletion Polymorphism of Angiotensin-Converting Enzyme as a Risk Factor for Chronic Allograft Nephropathy. *Transplantation Proceedings*, *42*(6), 2304–2308. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.transproceed.2010.05.020

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Szabó, L., Rusznák, Z., Sz{''}ucs, G., Asztalos, L., & Pál, B. (2010). Effect of Tacrolimus on the Excitatory Synaptic Transmission Between the Parallel Fibers and Pyramidal Cells in the Rat Dorsal Cochlear Nucleus. *Transplantation Proceedings*, *42*(6), 2339–2343. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.transproceed.2010.05.013

Asztalos, L., Olvasztó, S., Fedor, R., Szabó, L., Balázs, G., & Lukács, G. (2006). Renal Artery Aneurysm at the Anastomosis After Kidney Transplantation. *Transplantation Proceedings*, *38*(9), 2915–2918. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.transproceed.2006.08.115

Asztalos, L., Kincses, Z., Berczi, C., Szabó, L., Fedor, R., Lőcsey, L., & Balázs, G. (2001). [Acute Pancreatitis after Kidney Transplantation]. *Magyar Sebeszet*, *54*(2), 91.